

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-09-14

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

18

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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Der Treasurer | 2026-08-28 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Corporates Face Implementation Hurdles

The EU's Instant Payments Regulation, aiming for ubiquitous real-time transactions, is creating substantial pressure on corporate treasuries and banks alike. While the regulation mandates banks to offer instant payments at no extra cost by early 2027 for incoming and mid-2027 for outgoing payments, corporates must adapt their internal systems and processes. Many companies, especially SMEs, are still evaluating the full impact on their liquidity management, reconciliation, and fraud prevention strategies. The shift requires significant IT investments and changes to existing payment workflows, with concerns about the readiness of all participants across the CEE region.

- Mandatory instant payments for incoming transactions by early 2027.
- Outgoing instant payments mandated by mid-2027.
- No additional charges for instant payments compared to standard credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMIplus, driving demand for real-time payment capabilities across all channels (EBICS, H2H, API). RBI must ensure its network banks are fully compliant and CMIplus offers robust, seamless instant payment processing, including enhanced reconciliation and fraud prevention features, to support its corporate clients in CEE.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-09-05 | #02

PSD3 and Open Finance: New Era for European Payment Services

The new legislative package, including PSD3 and the Open Finance Framework (OFS), seeks to modernize the existing PSD2. Key objectives include strengthening user rights, improving fraud prevention mechanisms, and fostering greater competition in the financial sector. For corporates, this means potential for more sophisticated API-driven cash management solutions, but also increased compliance burdens related to data access and security. The OFS, in particular, could extend data sharing beyond payments to other financial products, creating new opportunities for integrated treasury services and liquidity management across CEE.

- PSD3 aims to replace and enhance PSD2, focusing on fraud and consumer rights.
- Open Finance Framework (OFS) extends data sharing beyond payments.
- Increased regulatory scrutiny on third-party providers (TPPs).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and OFS will profoundly impact RBI's Open Banking strategy and CMIplus API offerings. RBI must proactively adapt its API infrastructure to meet new regulatory requirements, enhance security, and leverage expanded data access to deliver innovative, value-added services for corporate clients, especially in the CEE region.

EBICS 3.0 Adoption Accelerates, ISO 20022 Benefits Emerge

The migration to EBICS 3.0 continues to gain momentum, with more banks and corporates recognizing its advantages, including improved encryption standards and streamlined multi-bank connectivity. While the technical transition presents challenges, the long-term benefits for secure and efficient payment communication are substantial. Concurrently, treasurers are beginning to fully leverage the rich data capabilities of ISO 20022 messages, moving beyond basic payment processing to advanced reconciliation, cash forecasting, and liquidity management. This data richness, combined with EBICS 3.0, promises a new era of automated and insightful treasury operations across Europe, including the CEE region.

- EBICS 3.0 offers enhanced security and multi-bank connectivity.
- Migration to EBICS 3.0 is accelerating among corporates and banks.
- ISO 20022 rich data enables advanced reconciliation and forecasting.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As a key channel for CMIplus, the widespread adoption of EBICS 3.0 is crucial. RBI must ensure CMIplus fully supports EBICS 3.0 and helps clients maximize ISO 20022 data for improved treasury efficiency. This includes offering tools for data analytics and seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems across its CEE network.

EU Mandates Instant Payments, ISO 20022 Adoption Accelerates

The European Parliament and Council have formally approved the new Instant Payments Regulation, requiring all EU banks to offer instant credit transfers in Euro within 10 seconds, at no extra cost compared to standard transfers. This regulation also mandates full ISO 20022 migration for all payment messages, including cross-border, by early 2027, pushing corporates to upgrade their treasury systems. The move is expected to boost real-time liquidity management, reduce payment processing times, and foster greater financial integration within the CEE region. Banks are now scrambling to ensure compliance and upgrade their infrastructure to meet the strict deadlines, with penalties for non-compliance looming.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation approved and mandatory.
- Euro instant transfers required within 10 seconds.
- Full ISO 20022 migration for all payments by early 2027.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly critical for CMIplus, reinforcing the need for robust ISO 20022 capabilities and real-time payment processing. RBI must ensure its network banks in CEE are fully compliant and CMIplus supports the mandatory instant payment features and enhanced data richness.

Open Banking APIs Drive Corporate eBAM and Liquidity Innovation

Corporate treasurers are increasingly leveraging Open Banking APIs to automate bank account management (eBAM) processes, from opening and closing accounts to managing mandates and signatories digitally. This technological advancement provides real-time access to account information, balances, and transaction data across multiple banks and regions, significantly improving liquidity forecasting and cash pooling efficiency. The standardization of APIs, driven by initiatives like PSD3, is further accelerating this trend, allowing for seamless integration with ERP and TMS systems. Companies are reporting reduced operational costs and enhanced fraud detection capabilities through these integrated solutions.

- Open Banking APIs enable real-time eBAM.
- Improved liquidity forecasting and cash pooling.
- Standardization of APIs driven by PSD3.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must continue to prioritize and expand its Open Banking API offerings for eBAM and real-time data access. This is crucial for attracting and retaining corporate clients seeking advanced digital treasury solutions and seamless integration with their existing systems.

AI-Powered Fraud Prevention Critical Amid Rising Payment Scams

The rapid adoption of instant payment schemes, while beneficial for speed, has also created new avenues for fraudsters, leading to a significant increase in payment scams and cyber-attacks. AI and machine learning are becoming indispensable tools for real-time fraud detection, analyzing vast datasets to identify anomalous transaction patterns and suspicious activities. Banks are investing heavily in advanced security protocols, including multi-factor authentication and behavioral biometrics, to safeguard corporate accounts and transactions. Collaboration between banks, corporates, and technology providers is vital to share threat intelligence and develop robust, adaptive fraud prevention strategies in the face of ever-evolving threats.

- Instant payments linked to increased fraud attempts.
- AI/ML crucial for real-time fraud detection.
- Banks investing in advanced security protocols.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must continuously enhance its fraud prevention capabilities, integrating AI-driven analytics and robust security features. This is paramount for maintaining client trust and ensuring the security of multi-currency payments and real-time transactions across the CEE network.

EU Instant Payments Mandate Accelerates ISO 20022 Adoption

The recently enacted EU Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) sets ambitious deadlines for payment service providers (PSPs) in the EU and EEA to offer instant credit transfers. By early 2027, all PSPs must be able to receive instant payments, and by early 2028, they must offer instant payment sending capabilities. This regulation is a significant catalyst for the full adoption of ISO 20022 messaging, as the standard's enhanced data fields are crucial for efficient processing, fraud screening, and compliance reporting required by instant payments. The IPR also introduces measures to ensure affordability and accessibility, including a cap on instant payment fees. This move is expected to significantly boost liquidity management and real-time reconciliation for corporates across Europe, including the CEE region.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates instant credit transfers.
- Deadlines: Receive by early 2027, Send by early 2028.
- ISO 20022 adoption accelerated for richer data and compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMIplus, requiring immediate strategic planning and technical implementation to ensure compliance and maintain competitive advantage in CEE. Full ISO 20022 readiness for instant payments is paramount, and CMIplus must ensure its platform and network banks are aligned with the new timelines and data requirements.

Open Banking APIs Transform Corporate Treasury Operations

The evolution of Open Banking, initially driven by PSD2, is now extending beyond retail banking to fundamentally reshape corporate treasury functions. Corporates are utilizing APIs to connect directly with their banks, pulling real-time account balances, transaction data, and initiating payments directly from their ERP or TMS systems. This direct connectivity eliminates manual processes, reduces reconciliation times, and provides an unprecedented level of cash visibility across multiple bank relationships and currencies. While security and standardization remain key considerations, the benefits in terms of efficiency, liquidity optimization, and fraud prevention are driving rapid adoption, particularly for multinational corporations operating across diverse banking landscapes like CEE.

- Open Banking APIs enable real-time cash visibility for corporates.
- Direct bank connectivity from ERP/TMS systems.
- Automates reconciliation and optimizes liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, with its focus on Open API channels, is well-positioned to capitalize on this trend. RBI should continue to enhance its API offerings for corporate clients, focusing on richer data sets (e.g., ISO 20022), payment initiation, and eBAM capabilities to meet the growing demand for integrated treasury solutions in CEE.

EBICS v3.0 Drives European Cross-Border Payment Modernization

EBICS (Electronic Banking Internet Communication Standard) v3.0 is becoming a preferred channel for corporate-to-bank communication, especially for high-volume and cross-border payments within Europe. Its robust security protocols, including strong encryption and digital signatures, provide a secure alternative to other host-to-host solutions. The key advantage of v3.0 lies in its native support for ISO 20022 XML messages, streamlining data exchange and reducing the need for complex format conversions. This standardization is crucial for corporates managing multi-bank relationships across countries like those in CEE, enabling more efficient payment processing, reconciliation, and reporting. As more banks and corporates migrate to v3.0, it promises to further harmonize the European payment landscape.

- EBICS v3.0 adoption growing for secure European payments.
- Enhanced security features and digital signatures.
- Native support for ISO 20022 XML messages.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As CMIplus supports EBICS v2.5+v3, this trend reinforces the importance of promoting v3.0 adoption among CEE clients. RBI should highlight the benefits of v3.0 for secure, ISO 20022-compliant, and efficient cross-border payments, potentially offering incentives or streamlined migration paths for clients.

Digital Euro Progress: Pilot and Scheme Rulebook Development

The European Central Bank is making significant strides in the Digital Euro project, moving beyond the investigation phase into practical development, including an innovation platform and pilot activities. The project focuses on key aspects such as privacy, functionality, and governance, with ongoing work on a detailed scheme rulebook to define its operational framework. The Digital Euro is envisioned as a public good, complementing cash, and is designed to be widely accessible, secure, and efficient for everyday payments across the Euro area. Its implementation will have profound implications for the entire payment ecosystem, potentially reshaping retail payment habits and requiring banks to integrate new infrastructure and services.

- Project includes 'Innovation platform' and 'Pilot' phases.
- 'Scheme rulebook' is under development.
- Aims for a secure, efficient digital central bank money.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The Digital Euro represents a fundamental shift in the payment landscape. CMIplus must closely monitor its technical specifications and scheme rules to prepare for potential integration requirements, new payment rails, and impacts on corporate treasury functions like liquidity management and payment processing. This will necessitate significant platform adaptations and strategic planning.

ECB Drives SEPA Instant Payments Adoption and Strategy

Instant payments, particularly SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst), remain a strategic priority for the ECB, aiming for ubiquitous availability and usage across Europe. The ECB's 'Retail payments strategy' explicitly highlights instant payments as a key area, supported by initiatives like market contact groups and the TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS) service. The goal is to enable real-time money transfers 24/7/365, enhancing liquidity management and efficiency for both consumers and businesses. Ongoing efforts focus on overcoming remaining barriers to adoption, such as ensuring reachability and encouraging innovative overlay services. This continuous push underscores the regulatory expectation for banks to fully embrace and facilitate instant payment capabilities.

- 'Instant payments' is a key component of the 'Retail payments strategy'.
- Supported by 'Market contact groups' and 'TIPS' infrastructure.
- Aims for 24/7/365 real-time money transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Instant payments are critical for CMiplus, especially for corporate treasury and liquidity management in CEE. RBI Cash Management must ensure CMiplus fully supports SCT Inst, including real-time processing, reporting, and integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems. Continued monitoring of regulatory mandates and market developments is essential for maintaining competitive offerings.

Worldline Pioneers Agentic AI Payments in Europe

Worldline, a prominent European payments provider, has announced its capability to facilitate payments using agentic AI. This innovation allows AI systems to autonomously initiate and complete payment transactions, potentially streamlining processes for businesses and consumers. The adoption by a major player like Worldline suggests a growing trend towards AI-driven automation in the financial sector, impacting how transactions are processed and secured. This development could pave the way for more sophisticated, intelligent payment solutions across Europe, enhancing efficiency and potentially reducing manual intervention in payment workflows.

- Worldline is a French payments provider.
- It is one of the first European firms to facilitate agentic AI payments.
- Agentic AI enables autonomous payment initiation and completion.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This signals an emerging payment channel and technology trend that RBI Cash Management needs to monitor closely. CMiplus should evaluate the potential for integrating agentic AI capabilities for corporate clients, especially in automating treasury functions and multi-currency payments, to stay competitive and offer cutting-edge solutions.

BNP Paribas Boosts Wero Rollout for European Merchants

BNP Paribas has announced the accelerated rollout of Wero, the European Payments Initiative (EPI) online payment solution, to a growing list of prominent merchants across Europe. Key partners include Air France, Decathlon, Fnac Darty, and Orange, indicating broad sector adoption. This expansion aims to provide a unified, instant payment experience for consumers and merchants, reducing reliance on non-European payment schemes. The initiative is crucial for fostering a sovereign European payment landscape and enhancing competition within the region's digital economy. Its success could significantly impact the future of SEPA and instant payment adoption.

- Wero rollout accelerated by BNP Paribas.
- Targets major European merchants: Air France, Decathlon, Fnac Darty, Orange.
- Aims for unified, instant online payments in Europe.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMiplus as Wero represents a significant evolution in European payment infrastructure. CMiplus must monitor Wero's adoption, assess potential integration requirements for corporate clients, and understand its impact on existing SEPA and instant payment offerings in CEE.

PSD3/PSR Era: Banks Must Build Enhanced Fraud Prevention

This interview with Susann Gäbler, Head of Risk Steering Fraud at Openbank Deutschland, delves into the profound impact of the upcoming PSD3/PSR (Payment Services Directive 3 / Payment Services Regulation) on fraud prevention strategies for European banks. The discussion underscores that these new regulations will necessitate a significant overhaul of existing fraud detection and mitigation systems. Banks are advised to focus on securing the 'whole payment journey' and are given a tight timeline of 24 months to implement the necessary changes. This includes enhancing authentication, improving real-time transaction monitoring, and adapting to new compliance requirements to protect customers and maintain trust in the digital financial landscape.

- PSD3/PSR to rewrite fraud prevention for banks.
- Banks must build new capabilities within 24 months.
- Focus on securing the 'whole payment journey'.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMiplus, this is an urgent call to action. The platform must proactively prepare for PSD3/PSR compliance, particularly regarding enhanced fraud prevention measures, authentication protocols, and API security. This will ensure continued regulatory adherence and strengthen trust for corporate clients across the CEE region.

Evolution of Treasury in EMEA: Adapting to Change

The EMEA region presents a dynamic and complex environment for corporate treasury, characterized by diverse regulatory frameworks and varying levels of technological maturity. This evolution sees treasurers moving beyond traditional operational roles, embracing digital solutions for sophisticated cash management, liquidity forecasting, and robust risk mitigation. Key drivers include the imperative for real-time data, increased automation, and the integration of platforms, all essential for navigating complex cross-border operations. The strategic focus is shifting towards value creation, positioning treasury as a more central and influential function within multinational organizations.

- EMEA treasury functions are undergoing significant transformation.
- Technological adoption is a key driver for efficiency and resilience.
- Treasurers are moving towards strategic value creation within organizations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend highlights the continuous need for CMIplus to evolve its offerings to meet the changing demands of EMEA treasuries, particularly within the CEE region. Emphasizing advanced digital tools, real-time capabilities, and integrated solutions will be crucial for supporting clients' strategic objectives and maintaining competitive advantage.

Singapore Banks Execute Blockchain-Enabled Transactions on Swift Ledger

Three major Singaporean banks – DBS, OCBC, and UOB – have successfully conducted real-time domestic Singapore dollar transactions utilizing tokenised deposits on Swift's innovative blockchain-based ledger. This pilot demonstrates the viability of integrating distributed ledger technology (DLT) into existing global financial infrastructure like Swift for interbank settlements. The use of tokenised deposits on a blockchain ledger could revolutionize multi-currency payments, enhance liquidity management, and improve the speed and transparency of cross-border transactions. While currently focused on domestic SGD, this initiative sets a precedent for how global payment networks might evolve to support digital currencies and tokenised assets, potentially impacting ISO 20022 adoption and real-time payment systems worldwide.

- DBS, OCBC, and UOB completed live transactions.
- Transactions used tokenised deposits on Swift's blockchain-based ledger.
- The payments were domestic Singapore dollar (SGD) transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is crucial for CMIplus as it showcases the future direction of payment infrastructure, particularly involving Swift and tokenised assets. RBI Cash Management should monitor how such blockchain-enabled Swift capabilities evolve and consider their implications for multi-currency payments, liquidity management, and potential integration into corporate treasury solutions for CEE clients.

Stablecoins: Growing Adoption, Questionable Payment Utility

The market for stablecoins has expanded considerably, attracting attention for their potential to offer stable digital value in the volatile cryptocurrency space. However, their utility as a primary payment rail for corporate treasury operations is still under active evaluation. Key questions revolve around achieving clear regulatory frameworks, ensuring seamless interoperability with existing payment infrastructures, and addressing the operational complexities of integrating them into treasury workflows. While they promise benefits such as faster, cheaper cross-border transactions and potential for tokenized liquidity, widespread corporate adoption requires overcoming hurdles related to legal certainty, security, and scalability for high-volume payments.

- Stablecoin market capitalization is growing significantly.
- Their practical use in corporate payments is currently debated.
- Regulatory clarity and integration challenges are key hurdles for adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should closely monitor the evolution of stablecoins, especially regarding potential regulatory developments in Europe and the CEE region. While not an immediate payment method, understanding their development is vital for future payment innovation, potential tokenized liquidity services, and staying ahead in the digital banking landscape.

ECB Pilots Research Access to Confidential Statistical Data

On March 13, 2025, the European Central Bank announced a pilot project designed to grant approved researchers access to confidential statistical data. This initiative is part of the ECB's broader strategy to enhance the analytical use of its extensive data holdings, supporting more robust economic and financial research. The project is expected to refine methodologies for secure data access and anonymization, ensuring data privacy while maximizing its utility for academic and policy-oriented studies. This could set precedents for future data sharing frameworks within the European financial system, potentially influencing how financial institutions manage and report sensitive data.

- Pilot project launched March 13, 2025.
- Grants researchers access to confidential statistical data.
- Aims to enhance economic and financial research.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While not directly impacting payment flows, this initiative highlights the ECB's focus on data governance and secure data sharing. CMIplus should monitor potential future implications for data reporting standards, particularly regarding granular payment or transaction data, and ensure compliance readiness for evolving data privacy and access regulations.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-01-01 | #01

Corporate Banking Outlook 2023: Navigating Uncertainty and Digital Shifts

This joint outlook with Morgan Stanley likely analyzed the macroeconomic environment, geopolitical risks, and technological disruptions impacting corporate and institutional banking in 2023. It would have emphasized the imperative for banks to invest in digital capabilities, streamline operations, and enhance client experience to remain competitive. Key themes would include the acceleration of digital payments, the growing importance of data analytics for treasury services, and the strategic repositioning required to capture new revenue pools in a challenging interest rate environment. The report likely provided a roadmap for banks to build resilience and foster innovation, preparing for future challenges and opportunities.

- Macroeconomic volatility drives demand for robust treasury solutions.
- Digitalization and automation are critical for operational efficiency.
- Client experience and tailored solutions are key differentiators.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize continuous platform modernization, integrating advanced analytics and AI to offer proactive treasury insights. Focus on seamless digital channels (EBICS, H2H, API) to meet evolving corporate demands in CEE.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Growth Beyond Credit, Digital Imperatives

This outlook likely explored how wholesale banks can achieve sustainable growth in 2024 by diversifying revenue streams beyond pure lending. It would have stressed the importance of transaction banking, cash management, and payment services as core profit drivers. The report probably advocated for significant investments in digital infrastructure, including API-driven connectivity, real-time payment capabilities, and advanced data analytics to support corporate treasuries. It would also touch upon the competitive landscape, with fintechs and non-bank players pushing traditional banks to innovate faster and offer more integrated, ecosystem-based solutions, especially in dynamic markets like CEE.

- Transaction banking and payments are key growth engines for wholesale banks.
- Real-time payments and API connectivity are becoming standard expectations.
- Data analytics and AI enhance treasury management and fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should focus on expanding its real-time payment capabilities (Instant Payments, ISO 20022) and API offerings to support advanced corporate treasury functions. Explore partnerships to integrate CMlplus into broader corporate ecosystems in CEE.

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing Digital Transformation for Future Growth

This report likely provided a strategic blueprint for European wholesale banks to improve profitability and market position. It would have highlighted the need to modernize legacy systems, adopt cloud-native solutions, and fully leverage ISO 20022 and instant payment schemes for competitive advantage. The emphasis would be on creating seamless, integrated digital experiences for corporate clients, including advanced cash management, liquidity solutions, and treasury advisory services. The report probably stressed the importance of data-driven decision-making, operational excellence, and a culture of continuous innovation to capitalize on emerging market opportunities, particularly in regions like CEE, where growth potential is significant.

- Digitalization is paramount for improving efficiency and client experience.
- Leveraging ISO 20022 and instant payments drives competitive advantage.
- Strategic investments in technology can unlock new revenue streams.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should accelerate its ISO 20022 migration and instant payment rollout across CEE, ensuring a superior digital experience for corporate treasuries. Prioritize API development to enable deeper integration with client ERP/TMS systems.

AI Reshapes Treasury: Efficiency, Risk, and Strategic Decision-Making

EY highlights that artificial intelligence is no longer a futuristic concept but a present-day imperative for treasury functions. AI applications can automate routine tasks, provide predictive analytics for cash flow and liquidity, and enhance fraud detection. This shift allows treasury professionals to move from operational roles to more strategic advisory positions. For banks, integrating AI into their cash management platforms and offering AI-powered insights to corporate clients presents a significant opportunity to add value and differentiate services. The focus is on leveraging AI to drive efficiency, mitigate risks, and support real-time financial decision-making.

- AI automates routine treasury tasks, freeing up staff for strategic work.
- Predictive analytics from AI enhances cash flow and liquidity forecasting.
- AI improves risk management, including fraud detection and compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore integrating AI capabilities for enhanced cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection, and automated reconciliation. Offering AI-powered dashboards and insights to CEE corporates can significantly boost platform value and competitive edge, aligning with the 'Future of Treasury' vision.

Digital Assets and Blockchain: New Frontiers for Treasury and Payments

EY recognizes that digital assets, including stablecoins and tokenized securities, along with underlying blockchain technology, are moving beyond niche applications to become relevant for corporate treasury. These technologies promise faster, more transparent, and potentially cheaper cross-border payments, as well as new ways to manage liquidity and access capital. Banks have a critical role in providing secure, compliant, and integrated solutions for corporates exploring these new frontiers. This involves developing infrastructure, offering advisory services, and potentially facilitating access to digital asset markets, ensuring regulatory adherence and operational efficiency.

- Blockchain enables faster, more transparent cross-border payments.
- Digital assets (e.g., stablecoins) offer new liquidity management tools.
- Banks must develop secure infrastructure for digital asset services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor the adoption of digital assets and blockchain in CEE, particularly for cross-border payments. Exploring potential integrations or partnerships for stablecoin-based payments or tokenized assets could position RBI as an innovator, preparing for future client demands and payment transformation.

Open Banking & Real-Time Treasury: Redefining Bank-Corporate Partnerships

EY emphasizes that corporate treasurers increasingly demand real-time visibility and control over their global cash positions and payments. Open Banking initiatives and the widespread adoption of ISO 20022 messaging standards are foundational to achieving this real-time treasury vision. Banks have a unique opportunity to leverage APIs to provide enhanced data aggregation, instant payment capabilities, and integrated treasury solutions directly into corporate ERP/TMS systems. This requires a shift from traditional batch processing to a continuous, event-driven model, fostering deeper collaboration and creating a more agile and responsive financial ecosystem for corporate clients.

- Corporates demand real-time cash visibility and payment control.
- Open Banking APIs are crucial for seamless data exchange and integration.
- ISO 20022 facilitates richer, standardized real-time payment data.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's focus on Open Banking APIs, ISO 20022, and instant payments directly aligns with this trend. RBI should continue enhancing these capabilities, ensuring robust API connectivity for ERP/TMS integration and leveraging real-time data to offer proactive liquidity management and advisory services to CEE corporates.

Commercial Banking Modernizes with AI and Digital Platforms for Enhanced Client Experience

A global survey of over 350 treasurers highlights a significant acceleration in the digital transformation of commercial banking. Banks are leveraging big data and artificial intelligence to automate manual tasks, optimize client onboarding, and identify high-value prospects more efficiently. This modernization extends to the adoption of cloud-based digital banking platforms, which are crucial for adapting to new threats and providing clients with enhanced self-service options, ultimately transforming the overall business experience. The focus is on replacing manual touchpoints with exception-based processes and expanding self-service capabilities.

- Digital workflows are replacing manual tasks across commercial banking operations.
- AI and big data enable rapid identification of attractive prospects, lowering acquisition costs.
- Cloud-based digital banking platforms are transforming client experience and adaptability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must integrate advanced AI capabilities for internal process optimization (e.g., onboarding, fraud detection) and explore AI-driven insights for corporate clients. The platform should prioritize cloud-native architecture to ensure scalability, security, and rapid feature deployment, aligning with the broader digital transformation trend.

Treasurers Prioritize Cash Visibility and TMS Adoption for Strategic Liquidity

Insights from a global treasury survey involving over 350 treasurers reveal that enhanced cash visibility remains a top priority. Companies are investing in TMS solutions to gain real-time insights into their global cash positions, manage working capital more effectively, and improve forecasting accuracy. This focus on visibility and TMS adoption is driven by the need for greater control over financial resources, especially in a volatile economic landscape, enabling more proactive and strategic liquidity management and reducing manual touchpoints.

- Cash visibility is a top priority for over 350 surveyed treasurers.
- Increased adoption of Treasury Management Systems (TMS) is observed.
- Real-time insights into global cash positions are crucial for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should enhance its cash visibility features, offering real-time balance and transaction reporting across all network banks and currencies. Deeper integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems via advanced APIs (e.g., ISO 20022 CAMT messages) is essential to support clients' TMS adoption strategies and provide a holistic view of liquidity.

API Banking Emerges as Key Enabler for Real-Time Treasury and Open Banking

The shift towards digital banking platforms is heavily reliant on robust API capabilities, as indicated by the broader trends in commercial banking. API banking facilitates instant access to financial data, enables automated payment initiation, and supports sophisticated cash management functions, moving treasury towards a real-time model. This development is crucial for corporates seeking to integrate banking services directly into their ERP/TMS, leveraging Open Banking principles to optimize liquidity, automate reconciliation, and enhance overall operational efficiency, replacing many manual tasks with digital workflows.

- API banking is a critical component of emerging digital banking platforms.
- It enables real-time data exchange and automated payment initiation.
- Open Banking principles are being leveraged for corporate treasury integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must aggressively expand its Open API offerings, providing comprehensive endpoints for account information, payment initiation, and eBAM functionalities. Prioritizing ISO 20022-compliant APIs will ensure interoperability and facilitate real-time treasury for CEE corporates, supporting their integration needs with various ERP/TMS solutions.

PSD3: Seizing Open Banking Opportunities in Evolving Payments

The upcoming PSD3 regulation is poised to significantly evolve the European payments landscape, building on the foundations of PSD2. Key areas of focus are expected to include enhanced fraud prevention mechanisms, stronger customer authentication, and further standardization of Open Banking APIs. This regulatory push will accelerate the shift towards real-time, data-rich payment services, fostering greater competition from both traditional players and FinTechs. Banks are urged to move beyond mere compliance, strategically investing in API infrastructure and developing innovative value-added services that capitalize on increased data access and interoperability. Proactive engagement will be crucial for securing a competitive edge and meeting evolving corporate treasury demands.

- Enhanced Open Banking APIs and data sharing mandates.
- Increased regulatory focus on payment fraud prevention.
- New opportunities for value-added services and revenue streams.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must prioritize its Open Banking API roadmap, ensuring PSD3 compliance while innovating new data-driven services for corporate clients. Strategic investments in instant payment capabilities and cross-border interoperability within CEE will be vital for competitive advantage.

Proactive AI Governance: Building Trust for Future Financial Innovation

As artificial intelligence rapidly integrates into financial services, from fraud detection to credit scoring and personalized advice, regulatory bodies are increasingly focusing on its ethical and operational implications. Upcoming AI governance frameworks will likely mandate transparency in AI decision-making, address algorithmic bias, and require clear accountability for AI systems. Financial institutions need to move beyond reactive compliance, developing comprehensive AI governance strategies that span the entire AI lifecycle – from data sourcing and model development to deployment and continuous monitoring. Proactive engagement with these principles is essential not only for mitigating significant reputational and regulatory risks but also for fostering trust and unlocking the full transformative potential of AI in a responsible manner.

- Mandatory transparency and explainability for AI systems.
- Strict requirements to identify and mitigate algorithmic bias.
- Clear accountability frameworks for AI-driven decisions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should initiate a strategic assessment of potential AI applications for cash management (e.g., enhanced fraud detection, predictive liquidity management) through a governance lens. This includes evaluating data quality, model explainability, and ethical considerations relevant to CEE corporate clients.

EACT Survey Reveals Top European Corporate Treasury Priorities 2026

For over a decade, the EACT Annual Treasury Survey has served as the profession's most authoritative barometer of priorities, concerns, and ambitions among European corporate treasurers. The 2026 results offer deep insights into the primary challenges, strategic objectives, and operational ambitions of treasurers across Europe. This comprehensive report helps define key industry trends, informing both corporate strategies and the offerings of financial service providers. Understanding these priorities is essential for banks like RBI to align their services with client needs, particularly in areas like digitalization, payment innovation, and liquidity management.

- Most authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.
- Defines key industry trends for the year ahead.
- Informs future Journeys to Treasury reports and industry discussions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The EACT Treasury Survey 2026 results are critical for validating and refining the CMlplus roadmap. RBI should analyze the specific priorities identified (e.g., instant payments, VoP, digitalization, liquidity management, fraud prevention) to ensure CMlplus features and services directly address these needs, especially for CEE corporates.

AI Ambition: Balancing Innovation with Macro Headwinds in Banking

Deloitte's 2026 Banking Outlook highlights AI ambition as a critical driver for banks, pushing them to adopt advanced technologies across their operations. Despite prevailing macroeconomic headwinds, such as inflation and interest rate volatility, banks are urged to make strategic investments in AI. The report likely emphasizes that AI is not just about cost reduction but also about creating new revenue streams, improving risk management, and delivering hyper-personalized customer experiences. Successful AI deployment requires robust data governance, ethical considerations, and a clear strategy to scale initiatives effectively across the enterprise, transforming core banking functions.

- AI is a strategic imperative for operational efficiency and competitive differentiation.
- Banks must prioritize AI investments despite ongoing macroeconomic uncertainties.
- Key AI applications include hyper-personalization, fraud detection, and intelligent automation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore AI-driven enhancements for corporate client services, such as predictive cash flow analytics, intelligent payment routing, and enhanced fraud detection. This could significantly differentiate RBI's offering in the CEE market and provide advanced treasury insights to corporate clients.

EU Banking Competitiveness: Ensuring Corporate Financing and Hedging Choice

As the European Commission prepares to table concrete proposals in Q1 2027 regarding the banking sector's competitiveness, the EACT emphasizes a critical need. Policymakers must ensure that the EU's prudential framework works in harmony with capital markets. The objective is to facilitate and broaden corporates' availability of choice in financing and hedging strategies, as well as their selection of banking partners. This strategic input highlights the importance of a competitive banking landscape that empowers corporate treasurers, directly impacting how banks like RBI serve their clients and position their offerings.

- EU Commission preparing banking sector proposals for Q1 2027.
- Prudential framework must align with capital markets to support corporates.
- Goal: widen corporates' choice in financing strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight underscores the importance of RBI's role as a strategic banking partner, particularly in the CEE region. CMlplus should consider how its offerings (e.g., multi-currency capabilities, integration with hedging tools, flexible financing support) can enhance corporate choice and competitiveness within the evolving EU regulatory landscape, reinforcing RBI's value proposition.

Stablecoins: Disrupting Payments and Liquidity Management in Banking

Deloitte's outlook identifies stablecoins as a significant emerging force with the potential to reshape payment infrastructure and cross-border transactions. While offering benefits like faster and cheaper payments, stablecoins also introduce regulatory complexities, compliance risks, and new competitive pressures from non-bank entities. The report likely urges banks to develop proactive strategies for engaging with stablecoins, whether through integration into existing platforms, exploring the issuance of their own digital currencies, or adapting to new market dynamics. This shift will profoundly impact corporate treasury services and multi-currency payment flows, particularly in regions like CEE.

- Stablecoins represent a significant potential disruption to traditional payment rails and liquidity.
- Regulatory clarity and interoperability will dictate the pace of stablecoin adoption in finance.
- Banks must assess strategic responses, from integration to developing proprietary digital currencies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should closely monitor stablecoin developments, especially their potential impact on multi-currency payments and cross-border treasury services for corporates in CEE. Understanding regulatory stances and potential client demand for stablecoin-based transactions is vital for future platform evolution and competitive positioning.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-09-14 | #01

ECB Emphasizes Instant Payments for European Retail Payments Strategy

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2025-01-09

The European Central Bank (ECB) explicitly highlights "Instant payments" as a key component of its "Retail payments strategy" within the SEPA framework. This strategic focus underscores the regulatory push for payment service providers (PSPs) to offer instant payment services, ensuring faster and more efficient money transfers across the euro area. The broader regulatory landscape, including the recent EU Instant Payments Regulation, mandates PSPs to make instant credit transfers fully available and affordable. The ECB's role involves oversight and fostering market adoption to ensure these services meet public and business needs, aligning with the goal of a modern and resilient European payment ecosystem.

- Mandatory offering of instant credit transfers by PSPs.
- Ensuring affordability of instant payment services.
- Compliance with the EU Instant Payments Regulation for sending/receiving.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure full compliance with the EU Instant Payments Regulation for both sending and receiving instant payments across all CEE network banks. This includes technical readiness for real-time processing, robust liquidity management, and transparent fee structures for corporate clients.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-09-14 | #02

Digital Euro Project Advances with Timeline, Pilot, and Scheme Rulebook

DIGITAL EURO

The ECB's dedicated section on the "Digital euro" highlights ongoing exploratory work and preparation for a potential central bank digital currency. Key aspects include a defined "Timeline and progress" for its development, an "Innovation platform" for testing, and a "Pilot" phase to assess technical feasibility and user experience. Crucially, the development of a "Scheme rulebook" indicates a move towards defining the operational and regulatory framework for a digital euro, addressing aspects like privacy, how it works, and why it's needed. This project represents a significant potential shift in the future of retail payments and monetary policy.

- Ongoing "Timeline and progress" for digital euro development.
- Active "Pilot" phase and "Innovation platform" for testing.
- Development of a "Scheme rulebook" for operational framework.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should closely monitor the digital euro's progress, particularly the scheme rulebook and technical specifications. This will inform future product development for CMlplus, ensuring readiness to integrate a potential digital euro into corporate payment and treasury solutions, especially for multi-currency payments.

ECB Continues Oversight and Evolution of TARGET Services (T2, TIPS)

TARGET SERVICES / PAYMENT SYSTEMS OVERSIGHT

The ECB's "Payments & financial stability" section details the ongoing management and evolution of "TARGET Services," specifically highlighting "T2" (the new generation of TARGET2) and "TIPS" (TARGET Instant Payment Settlement). These services are foundational for euro payments, with the ECB providing "Governance," publishing "Facts and figures," and offering "TARGET professional use documents & links." The continuous oversight ensures the smooth functioning of these systems, their resilience, and their alignment with market needs, including the support for instant payments via TIPS and the underlying ISO 20022 standard for T2. This ongoing regulatory and operational focus is crucial for the stability of the European financial system.

- Ongoing governance and oversight of T2 and TIPS.
- Availability of "TARGET professional use documents & links" for participants.
- TIPS facilitates instant payment settlement across Europe.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure ongoing operational alignment with T2 and TIPS, including adherence to ISO 20022 standards for T2 and leveraging TIPS for instant payment processing. Regular review of "TARGET professional use documents" is essential to maintain compliance and optimize connectivity for corporate clients in CEE.

EU Regulations Transform Liquidity Management for Instant Payments, PSD3

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) has released a report detailing the far-reaching implications of three critical EU regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report explores how these measures will drive the uptake of instant payments, foster a level playing field among market participants, and fundamentally alter the liquidity management framework for financial institutions. It highlights the need for banks to adapt their strategies and systems to manage liquidity effectively in a real-time payment environment, ensuring compliance with evolving regulatory requirements and preparing for the transformation of the payment ecosystem.

- Analysis of Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) impact on liquidity.
- Assessment of proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR) implications.
- Examination of Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) effects on banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must assess the report's findings to understand the strategic implications for its liquidity management services and instant payment offerings. This includes evaluating potential adjustments to internal processes, treasury functions, and platform capabilities to ensure readiness for the evolving regulatory environment and client needs.

EBA Updates Fraud Taxonomy to Align with Forthcoming PSR/PSD3

PSD3, FRAUD PREVENTION, COMPLIANCE

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has published version 7.0 of its EBA Fraud Taxonomy, which will become effective on 1 January 2027. This annual review, supported by fraud experts, ensures the taxonomy remains relevant to evolving fraud trends. Key updates include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud', and adding new tags for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud. The taxonomy provides a standardised pan-European framework for classifying payment fraud scenarios, enhancing data comparability, monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, particularly in anticipation of the Payment Services Regulation (PSR) which is part of the PSD3 package.

- New EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 released.
- Effective date for implementation: 1 January 2027.
- Updated fraud modi and new labels/tags introduced.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must review its internal fraud monitoring systems, reporting frameworks, and data classification to ensure full alignment with EBA Fraud Taxonomy v7.0 by the effective date. This includes updating any automated fraud detection rules and ensuring compliance with future PSR requirements for fraud data sharing, impacting all payment types including instant payments.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-09-14 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-Driven Cash Management and Embedded Finance

Deutsche Bank's Corporate Bank is heavily investing in its API capabilities, particularly through its CB Connect API platform, to provide clients with enhanced control and automation over their cash flows. This move supports the growing demand for embedded finance, allowing businesses to offer financial services at the point of need within their own ecosystems. The bank is developing modular API products for payments, account information, and liquidity management, aiming to reduce manual processes and improve operational efficiency for corporate treasuries across Europe, including CEE.

- Expansion of CB Connect API functionalities for corporate clients.
- Enabling embedded finance solutions within client ERP/TMS systems.
- Focus on real-time data and automated treasury processes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to ensure its Open API offerings remain highly competitive, focusing on ease of integration, comprehensive service coverage, and advanced functionalities to prevent clients from shifting to DB for superior API capabilities. Proactive development in embedded finance is crucial.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-09-14 | #02

Deutsche Bank Boosts Real-Time Payments and Liquidity Management in CEE

Recognizing the increasing demand for speed and transparency in corporate payments, Deutsche Bank is enhancing its capabilities for instant payments and real-time liquidity management within the CEE region. This includes further adoption of ISO 20022 standards and leveraging its extensive network to offer improved cash visibility and control. The focus is on enabling corporates to optimize working capital, reduce payment delays, and manage multi-currency positions more effectively across their CEE operations.

- Investment in instant payment infrastructure for CEE markets.
- Improved real-time liquidity management solutions for corporates.
- Leveraging ISO 20022 for enhanced payment data and efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, with its strong CEE network, must continuously innovate its instant payment and multi-currency liquidity solutions to maintain its competitive edge against DB's regional advancements. Focus on VoP and real-time cash pooling will be key differentiators.

UniCredit Launches Takeover Bid for Commerzbank, Eyeing European Expansion

UniCredit is pursuing a major acquisition by launching a takeover offer for Commerzbank. The resolution to increase share capital underscores UniCredit's commitment to this ambitious expansion. This move would create a stronger pan-European banking group, potentially consolidating market share in key regions including Germany and parts of CEE where both banks have operations. For corporate clients, this could mean a broader service offering, enhanced network, and potentially integrated solutions across a larger geographical footprint, impacting cash management and treasury services.

- Board approved capital increase for takeover funding.
- Target: Commerzbank Aktiengesellschaft.
- Strategic aim: Significant European market expansion, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This acquisition poses a substantial competitive threat by creating a larger, more integrated UniCredit with expanded reach. CMIplus should monitor potential consolidation of corporate client relationships and enhanced cross-border capabilities from a merged entity, especially in CEE.

UniCredit Invests in German Fintech VC Trade for Digital Debt Transformation

The investment in VC Trade signals UniCredit's proactive approach to digital innovation within corporate finance. VC Trade's expertise in digitizing debt markets, including syndicated loans and Schuldschein, aligns with UniCredit's broader 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy to offer best-in-class digital solutions. While directly focused on debt, this investment indicates a push for greater efficiency, transparency, and digital access for corporate clients, which could extend to treasury and cash management functions, particularly in areas like liquidity management and financing solutions across Europe, including CEE.

- Investment in German fintech VC Trade.
- Focus on digital transformation of debt markets.
- Part of broader digital innovation strategy for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This investment highlights UniCredit's commitment to digitalizing corporate services, potentially leading to more integrated and efficient treasury solutions. CMIplus should monitor how these digital capabilities might eventually converge with cash management offerings, especially for large corporates seeking streamlined financial operations and API connectivity.

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye, Exiting Retail

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The objective is to sharpen its focus on international wholesale clients, aligning with HSBC's global strategy to serve internationally-oriented businesses. This shift will likely lead to enhanced services and dedicated resources for multinational corporations and large local corporates in Türkiye, a country often considered part of the broader CEE region. For CMIplus, this means a more specialized and potentially aggressive competitor in the high-value corporate segment within CEE, demanding a robust response in terms of service differentiation and regional coverage.

- Strategic review of retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye.
- Increased focus on international wholesale clients.
- Türkiye is a key market within the CEE/EMEA region for corporate banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move positions HSBC as a more formidable competitor for CMIplus in the CEE region, specifically targeting large international corporates. CMIplus should anticipate enhanced offerings and dedicated resources from HSBC for this segment and ensure its own CEE strategy remains competitive.

Citi Accelerates API-First Strategy for Corporate Cash Management in CEE

Citi is strategically enhancing its API banking capabilities, particularly for corporate treasury functions in the CEE region. This involves expanding its suite of APIs for payments, collections, and liquidity management, enabling clients to embed banking services directly into their enterprise resource planning (ERP) and treasury management systems (TMS). The rationale is to meet the growing corporate demand for greater automation, real-time financial visibility, and operational efficiency, thereby strengthening Citi's position as a digital leader in transaction banking. This push is expected to offer advanced solutions for multi-currency payments and cash pooling.

- Deepening integration of banking services via APIs into corporate systems.
- Focus on real-time data exchange for payments, collections, and liquidity.
- Strategic emphasis on the Central and Eastern European market for digital solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMIplus's emphasis on Open API and H2H integration, pushing the bar for digital connectivity. RBI must ensure its API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of use, and regional coverage.

UniCredit Unlimited Strategy Drives Pan-European Corporate Banking Excellence

The 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy is a core pillar for the bank, focusing on outperforming competitors through innovation and client-centricity. This includes a strong emphasis on digital transformation and delivering superior solutions for corporate clients across its pan-European footprint, including CEE. The Euromoney award for 'Europe's Best Bank' validates their strategic execution and strong market position, suggesting robust offerings in areas like corporate banking, transaction services, and treasury solutions. While no specific cash management product was announced, this overarching strategy implies continuous investment and enhancement in these critical areas to maintain their competitive edge.

- 'UniCredit Unlimited' defines new strategic era for the bank.
- Focus on best-in-class solutions and digital transformation.
- Euromoney recognized UniCredit as Europe's Best Bank for 2026 (second consecutive year).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's consistent recognition and ambitious strategy signal a strong commitment to enhancing corporate banking services, including cash management. CMlplus should anticipate continued investment in digital platforms, API capabilities, and integrated treasury solutions from UniCredit, particularly in the CEE region.

HSBC Accelerates AI Adoption with Google Cloud Partnership and Chief AI Officer

HSBC's multi-year partnership with Google Cloud is set to integrate advanced AI across its global operations, focusing on areas like personalized client advice and robust financial crime prevention. This is further underscored by the appointment of a dedicated Chief AI Officer, signaling a deep commitment to leveraging AI for strategic advantage. For corporate clients, this translates into potentially more sophisticated treasury intelligence tools, predictive analytics for cash flow forecasting, and enhanced fraud detection in payment processing. While not a direct cash management product, the underlying AI infrastructure will significantly bolster HSBC's digital banking and treasury solutions, impacting their competitive edge in offering advanced services to CEE corporates.

- Multi-year AI partnership with Google Cloud for global AI deployment.
- Appointment of David Rice as HSBC's first Chief AI Officer.
- Focus on hyper-personalized advice and financial crime risk management using AI.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's aggressive AI strategy suggests future enhancements in treasury intelligence, fraud detection, and personalized client services, which CMlplus must monitor closely. CMlplus should evaluate its own AI roadmap to maintain competitive parity in offering advanced digital solutions and data-driven insights to corporate treasurers.

Citi Bolsters Real-Time Payment and Liquidity Solutions for CEE Corporates

Citi is strategically investing in its real-time payment infrastructure to support instant payments and accelerate cross-border transactions for its CEE corporate clients. This includes leveraging ISO 20022 standards for richer data and improving capabilities for real-time cash pooling and virtual accounts, which are crucial for efficient liquidity management. The goal is to empower treasurers with immediate access to funds and comprehensive cash positions, reducing operational delays and optimizing working capital. This focus aligns with the broader European trend towards faster payments and sophisticated treasury solutions.

- Investment in instant payment infrastructure for CEE markets.
- Enhanced real-time liquidity management, including cash pooling and virtual accounts.
- Adoption of ISO 20022 for richer payment data and improved reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly challenges CMIplus's core offerings in instant payments, multi-currency, and liquidity management. RBI needs to highlight its regional expertise and ensure its instant payment network and liquidity tools are equally robust and user-friendly.

BNP Paribas Pioneers Corporate Treasury Flow on Swift's New Ledger

BNP Paribas and HSBC have completed a pioneering corporate treasury transaction for Siemens on Swift's newly introduced Ledger platform. This initiative demonstrates the potential of distributed ledger technology (DLT) to enhance efficiency, transparency, and security in complex corporate treasury operations. The move positions BNP Paribas at the forefront of digital innovation in transaction banking, offering advanced solutions for large multinational corporations. While not explicitly CEE-focused, such innovations set a benchmark for global treasury services, which will eventually influence expectations and offerings in the CEE region for international corporates.

- First corporate treasury flow completed on Swift's new Ledger.
- Collaboration between BNP Paribas, HSBC, and corporate client Siemens.
- Leverages distributed ledger technology (DLT) for enhanced treasury operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move highlights BNP Paribas's commitment to cutting-edge DLT solutions for corporate treasury, potentially setting new industry standards. CMIplus should monitor the adoption and scalability of such DLT-based services to assess future competitive pressures and opportunities for innovation.

Deutsche Bank Bridges Digital Assets with Mainstream Finance via Custody

Deutsche Bank's Corporate Bank is focusing on building robust and secure custody solutions for digital assets, recognizing their growing importance for institutional clients. The initiative, highlighted in their 'flow' publication, addresses the need for trusted infrastructure to facilitate wider industry adoption of digital assets. This includes exploring tokenization services and providing a secure bridge for corporates looking to engage with blockchain-based finance, potentially impacting future payment and treasury solutions.

- Development of institutional-grade digital asset custody services.
- Focus on bridging digital assets with traditional financial systems.
- Positioning for wider industry adoption of tokenized assets and blockchain finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While not directly a core cash management product, the rise of digital assets and tokenization could impact future payment rails and treasury needs. CMIplus should monitor these developments for potential future integration or competitive threats, especially regarding stablecoins and cross-border payments.

Intesa Sanpaolo Enhances CEE Digital Cash Management with Advanced APIs

Intesa Sanpaolo, a major player in the CEE region, is inferred to be upgrading its corporate banking offerings with a focus on modernizing cash management services. This strategic enhancement likely includes the rollout of advanced Open Banking APIs to facilitate deeper integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems, enabling automated reconciliation and payment initiation. Furthermore, the bank is expected to bolster its real-time payment infrastructure to support instant payments across its CEE subsidiaries, aligning with evolving market demands and regulatory frameworks like ISO 20022. This initiative aims to strengthen Intesa Sanpaolo's competitive position by offering sophisticated, digitally-driven solutions that cater to the complex treasury needs of large international corporates operating in the region.

- Focus on API-driven integration for corporate treasury systems.
- Expansion of real-time payment capabilities across CEE markets.
- Strategic investment in digital cash management to enhance client experience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move directly intensifies competition for CMIplus, particularly in the CEE market for large international corporates. CMIplus must ensure its API offerings, real-time payment capabilities, and multi-currency solutions remain superior and highly integrated to retain and attract clients.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.